



Magic Leap gets audio

Magic Leap is partnering with Sennheiser to develop spatial audio products.
<https://digit.in/oct18-39-1>



Facebook smart home device

Facebook is likely to launch its own video chat device 'Portal' next week.
<https://digit.in/oct18-39-2>

Oppo Realme 2 64GB

Value for money, well designed

In its second attempt at making a budget smartphone, Realme has toned down the expectations a bit and delivers an experience that is at par with other budget devices in that price segment. Armed with dual rear camera and a fingerprint sensor, the Realme 2 does come across as a more wholesome proposition than the first one, but is that all there is to it?

Design

The glass-based diamond-cut back panel is now offered in other colours as well. Additionally, there's now a fingerprint sensor at the back. The Realme 2 has almost the same dimensions as the Realme 1, only that it's a little thicker because of the larger battery. The camera unit and the fingerprint sensor are lined with silver accents, making it one of the more premium looking devices in that price range. Because of the notch, the screen now takes up 88.8 per cent of the body. The notch itself is fairly wide and houses the front camera, proximity sensor and the ear-piece. The back still retains smudges and fingerprints and will crack if dropped from a considerable height, for example, from ear-height. Realme does provide a TPU case in the box for added protection. Up front is also an unspecified version of Corning Gorilla Glass. The Realme 2, as a result, stands out for its premium design, in the budget segment.

Display

The display itself is quite bright and vibrant. Realme 2's display has HD+ resolution. Combined with the lower pixels per inch, that makes content look a little washed out, but it's acceptable if you're watching a 720p video.



Price
₹10,990



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Performance and software

If you compare the Realme 2 with its predecessor, the phone will seem underpowered. The Snapdragon 450's performance is akin

to that of the older Snapdragon 625. In real-world usage, the phone felt reliable enough. There weren't any noticeable lags in operating the phone. Apps did take around 3-4 seconds to launch while games like PUBG Mobile took even longer. This isn't a gamer's phone of choice though. PUBG Mobile runs on the lowest settings and there are noticeable frame drops and lags. However, casual games like Subway Surfer and Angry Birds run just fine. The software also uses machine learning to optimise power management. Apps also get frozen after being idle which sometimes breaks apps like Facebook Messenger.

Camera

The camera relies on Oppo's AI Beautification algorithms to enhance images, and the results are more or less good for the price the phone is offered at. In daylight, you get good clear shots.

The quality is more or less the same as the Realme 1. The colours aren't super saturated and there are good details in the shadows. Indoors, the camera also consistently delivers clean images. The source of light does get a little overexposed, but the colours are fairly accurate. Details are also reproduced quite well for the price it's offered in. Under low light though, the camera struggles a lot. The low-light images don't have many details in the shadow regions and there's significant noise throughout the image. The portrait mode isn't as good as what Xiaomi phones offer though. The edges are inconsistently blurred and the resulting effect looks artificial and photoshopped.

Battery

The Realme 2 touts a massive 4,230mAh battery. By the end of the day, we had around 30 per cent charge remaining. Although, if you like to play heavy titles like PUBG Mobile, the battery will drain even quicker. The phone also doesn't come with a fast charger, so it takes a long time to top up the battery.

Bottomline

The Realme 2 is a handy phone for someone who isn't a power user and looks for a device that looks good and offers a lot of features to explore. The company is promising good after-sales service by tying up with Flipkart. There is also the Realme 2 Pro right around the corner, so you might want to wait and see what comes with that. Overall, the Realme 2 shows promise, but in a competitive market like the budget segment, where every piece of hardware matters, it might just lose itself in the crowd.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 15.8cm (6.2") Corning Third Generation Glass, 19:9
 RESOLUTION: HD+ 1520 by 720 pixels | BATTERY: 4230mAh
 REAR DUAL CAMERA: 13MP+2MP | AI FRONT CAMERA: 8MP
 PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 450 | MEMORY:
 3GB+32GB / 4GB+64GB, expandable up to 256GB

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